

SPAIN

Spain – Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Kingdom of Spain
Short Form	Spain
Capital	Madrid
Region (UN)	Western European and Others Group (WEOG)
Government Type	Parliamentary Constitutional Monarchy
Head of State	King Felipe VI
Head of Government	Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez Pérez-Castejón
Currency	Euro (€)
UN Member Since	14 December 1955
MUN Standing	Active contributor in peacekeeping, human rights, and sustainable development; often advocates for multilateralism and international cooperation.

Recommended Books on Spain's Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

1. **"Contemporary Spanish Foreign Policy"** – David Garcia Cantalapiedra and Ramon Pacheco Pardo
2. **"Spain and the United Nations: The Quest for International Recognition"** – Manuel Pérez González
3. **"The Foreign Policy of Spain: A European Perspective"** – Charles Powell
4. **"Spain's Transition to Democracy: The Politics of Constitution-Making"** – José María Maravall
5. **"Spain and the European Union"** – Carlos Closa and Paul Heywood

Research Table: Spain & the UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR Country Profile – Spain	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/spain	Country-specific human rights profile and updates.
Spain's Universal Periodic Review (UPR)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/es-index	Spain's UPR reports, recommendations, and government responses.

OHCHR Treaty Body Database – Spain	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/Countries.aspx?CountryCode=ESP&Lang=EN	Access to Spain's submissions and observations under human rights treaties.
Amnesty International – Spain Report	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/spain/report-spain/	Annual report on civil liberties and rights abuses.
Human Rights Watch – Spain	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/spain	Reports and campaigns focusing on Spain's human rights record.
Spain – ECHR Judgments	https://hudoc.echr.coe.int/eng#%7B%22respondent%22%3A%5B%22ESP%22%5D%7D	All European Court of Human Rights cases involving Spain.
Freedom House – Spain Country Report	https://freedomhouse.org/country/spain/freedom-world/2024	Analysis of Spain's democratic performance and liberties.
Refworld – Spain Human Rights Documentation	https://www.refworld.org/country,,HRW,,ESP,,0.html	Repository of international human rights documents related to Spain.
UN Digital Library – Spain Human Rights Statements	https://digitallibrary.un.org/search?ln=en&cc=Meetings&sf=title&so=a&rg=50&c=Meetings&f1=author&v1=Spain	Archive of Spain's statements on human rights topics.
Global Alliance of National Human Rights Institutions – Spain	https://ganhri.org/members/spain/	Spain's national human rights body accreditation status.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
United Nations – Spain Profile	UN Human Rights Profile: Spain	Official UN OHCHR country page with treaty status, reports, and recommendations. Essential for UN-level human rights context.
Human Rights Watch (HRW) – Spain	Spain Overview	NGO analysis of human rights challenges in Spain, including minority rights and migration. Useful for critical perspectives on Spain's human rights record.
Spanish Ombudsman (Defensor del Pueblo)	Defensor del Pueblo	Spain's national human rights institution, responsible for monitoring rights protection. Useful for domestic accountability and reports.

Council of Europe – Spain	Spain and Human Rights	European-level human rights context involving Spain, important for comparing UN and regional norms.
International Justice Resource Center (IJRC)	Spain Human Rights Law	Resource for international and domestic human rights law applicable in Spain. Useful for legal research.
OHCHR – Spain Treaty Reporting	Spain Treaty Reports	Official UN treaty monitoring reports submitted by Spain. Useful for primary source documentation.
Amnesty International Report 2024	AI Spain Report	Detailed NGO report on rights challenges and reforms. Useful for human rights trends and advocacy.
International Federation for Human Rights (FIDH)	FIDH Spain	Reports on human rights conditions and activism in Spain. Useful for civil society perspective.
The Guardian – Spain Human Rights	Guardian Coverage	International perspective on Spain's rights issues. Useful for global context.
Global Detention Project – Spain	Detention Practices	Details on detention of migrants and refugees in Spain. Useful for legal and rights analysis.

Unique Aspects of Spain in the UNHRC Context

1. **Active Regional Human Rights Leadership:** Spain holds an important position in both the UN Human Rights Council and the Council of Europe, acting as a vital link between regional and global human rights initiatives.
2. **Complex Internal Political Context Impacting Rights:** The topics of Catalanian independence and regional autonomy bring about distinct human rights challenges, which in turn shape Spain's interactions with the UN Human Rights Council.
3. **Migration and Refugee Gateways:** Spain serves as a key gateway into Europe for migrants, making it a focal point in UNHRC discussions surrounding migration, asylum, and the protection of refugees.
4. **Strong Legal Protections for LGBTQ+ Rights:** Spain is well-known around the world for its forward-thinking laws that safeguard the rights of sexual and gender minorities. It's often highlighted as a shining example in discussions at UN forums.
5. **Active Civil Society and National Human Rights Institution:** Spain's Ombudsman, along with proactive NGOs, plays a crucial role in ensuring strong domestic oversight, which in turn boosts Spain's credibility during discussions at the UN Human Rights Council.
6. **Integration of EU Human Rights Norms:** Spain aligns its human rights policies with EU standards, showcasing a comprehensive approach to protecting rights.
7. **Historical Legacy of Authoritarianism:** Spain's journey from dictatorship to democracy plays a crucial role in shaping its approach to human rights advocacy, with a strong focus on preventing abuses.
8. **Environmental Rights on the UNHRC Agenda:** Spain is progressively connecting human rights with environmental protection, mirroring wider global trends seen in UNHRC discussions.
9. **Commitment to Gender Equality:** Spain has put in place some thorough gender equality laws and is actively championing these initiatives in discussions and resolutions at the UN Human Rights

Council.

10. **Balancing National Security and Rights:** Spain is grappling with the tough task of balancing anti-terrorism measures with the protection of individual rights, a subject that frequently comes under the microscope in UN discussions.
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